Proteas and focus on ending my career as a specialist T20 player for teams like the Cape Cobras, the Deccan Chargers and in county cricket. When I was spending time alone in one of my many hotel rooms in India during the 2010 IPL tournament – I spent a lot of time in my room, given that we weren't allowed outside the grounds for security reasons – I came very close to calling it a day.

But then the UCB offered me another contract in April 2010, when all our contracts came up for renewal. Donné and I had a long chat about my future, as I really did not want to be messed around any more. It wasn't good for my head and it wasn't good for my cricket.

As contracts always seem to do, they just appear in your email inbox one day. It's weird, I know. Nobody discusses anything with you beforehand, nor is there any kind of negotiation. The contract simply arrives in your inbox with an instruction to print it, sign it and return it. I know, for example, of one senior Proteas player who recently read his contract to find he'd been dropped two categories … it was the first he knew about it. This guy has been a mainstay in the batting line-up for the past three years and he suddenly finds he no longer has an A- or B-category contract. As you may well imagine, he's one unhappy Protea.

But this is the way it's always been. I mean, it's not like the coach sits you down and says, 'We'd like to offer you a new contract – do you want one?' There's no opportunity to say (if you wanted to), 'Look, coach, I think I've done my time and I'm thinking of retiring.' Nope, the contract just arrives. All the players know when the contracts are due, and I guess if yours doesn't arrive, you know you're out of the mix. So, ja, like I said. Strange.

Anyway, so now I have a new contract until April 2011, which will include the World Cup in India, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh, starting in February. Which is great – I've made no bones about the fact that winning a World Cup would mean everything to me; it's the one medal I've wanted the most in my career. So all's good. Or not.

When the selectors then dropped me for the May/June 2010 West Indies ODI series, I thought: Go figure. How can I be in their plans for the next World Cup when I'm left out of the team for a major series eight months before the start of the biggest tournament in world cricket?

So that's where I am with the South African team at the moment. I just have to keep on smiling and not let myself get too down about it. I guess